



Game Design

China is developing rapidly, and the appearance of cities and lifestyles have changed dramatically, which has caused people to have a strong sense of separation. As a result, the Internet has set off a wave of nostalgia for the millennium among young people. People call this kind of work Chinese DreamCore, which resonates with many people who grew up in the millennium. Therefore, I designed a game with 2008 as the background, taking people back to their childhood or making up for the regrets of the past. At the same time, it warns people to cherish the present, and perhaps being dissatisfied with the present is also a beautiful memory in the future.

Individual Project 2024.04

DREAM TRACE

International Designer Club Awards 2024: Pro Level, Nominations Award (international level)

BACKGROUND RESEARCH

Phenomenon



Recently, "old photos in the style of 2000s" have become popular on the Chinese Internet which people call them Chinese Dreamcore.

These dreamy and weird works have resonated strongly with people born between 1990 and 2005 and grew up in city or town.

What Is Chinese Dreamcore



Chinese Dreamcore works are visually simulating the image style of the period from the late 90s to the early 00s, combining China's unique cultural item, which makes people feel like a dream since.

The unique image texture of the millennium is reproduced through the "old-fashioned" technique, such as adding grain, blur, blue filter.

Reason

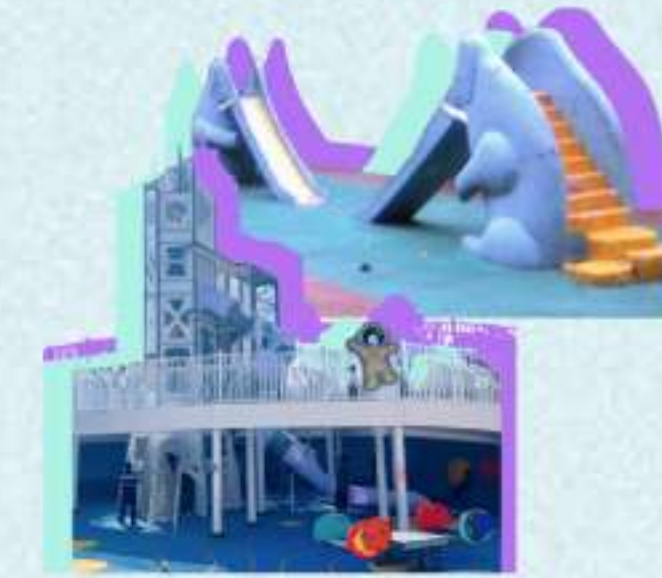
Changes In Architecture And Decoration



Building



Furnish



Park



School

Development Of Information Technology

Online social media becomes more popular



The rise of e-commerce



Popularity of mobile payment and life service APPs



Popularity of AI chat



Conclusion

- In recent years, China's economy has entered a difficult period. People are pessimistic and negative, and miss the prosperous days in the millennium.
- China has undergone significant changes over the past decade, with rapid urbanization causing major environmental transformations.
- The rapid growth of information technology has transformed people's lifestyles. The generation born between the 90s and 00s grew up in the collision of two eras, feeling a huge sense of separation.

BRAIN STORM

Start

2.PARK

File Edit Search Help

- SCENES: lake, store
- NPC: vendor
- EVENT: paly fishing game, boating
- ITEMS: ticket, toy, 0.5 ¥ snack



3.SHCOOL

File Edit Search Help

- SCENES: classroom, store
- NPC: teacher, classmate
- EVENT: exam, play card game
- ITEMS: stationery, test paper, book



4.HOME

File Edit Search Help

- SCENES: bedroom, living room
- NPC: parents
- EVENT: watch TV , play game
- ITEMS: computer, TV, Tamagotchi



VR

2023 data loading completed

access exit

5.HOME

- SCENES: bedroom
- NPC: robot
- EVENT: world war III, close people leave
- ITEMS: VR, photograph



Uploading...

1.HOME

File Edit Format View Help

- SCENES: bedroom
- NPC: ???
- EVENT: epidemic, failure at work
- ITEMS: childhood diary



GAME INTRODUCE

This is a nostalgic, story-telling, first-person game about Chinese Dreamcore. The purpose is to allow players to return to the happiness of 2008 and make up for the regrets of childhood. At the same time, **it warns people not to indulge in the past but enjoy the present.**

The story begins in 2023. You are frustrated in life and miss the past. **You accidentally travel back to 2008 through your childhood diary and spend the days in the park, school, and home described in the diary, but you find that 2023 is not the real world. You enter the virtual world through VR in 2050, and a world war breaks out in 2050.** The player realizes that the unsatisfied present is also a beautiful memory of the future. In the end, the player must choose between staying in the virtual world or facing reality.

MINI GAME DESIGN

Fishing Game

Design Element

Inflatable fishing game:
Common in parks. Use
magnet-tipped rods to
catch the toy fish.



Electronic fishing toy:
Catch the plastic fish that
randomly pops its head
out and opens its mouth.

Gameplay Reference

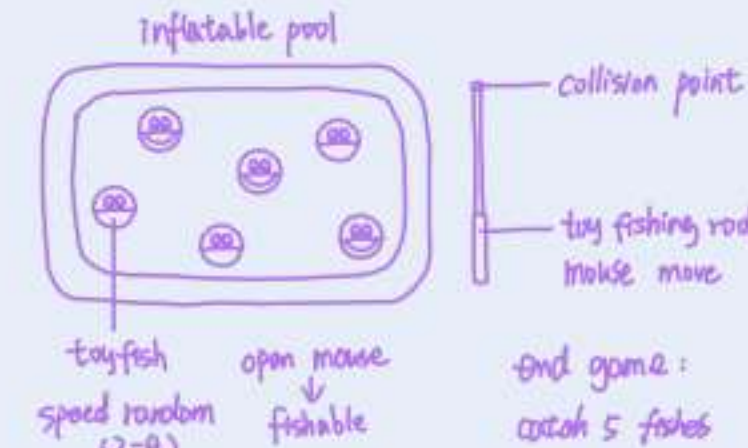


Mouse position:
Hammer position

Whack-a-Mole:
Player uses the
mouse to control
the hammer to
hit the randomly
appearing mole.

Left click:
Hammer down

Sketch



Card Game

Design Element

Hit card (hua pian):
Chinese children's game
that have been popular
since the 1980s.



Gameplay:
Players take turn to hit
the card. The winner flips
the card and keeps it.

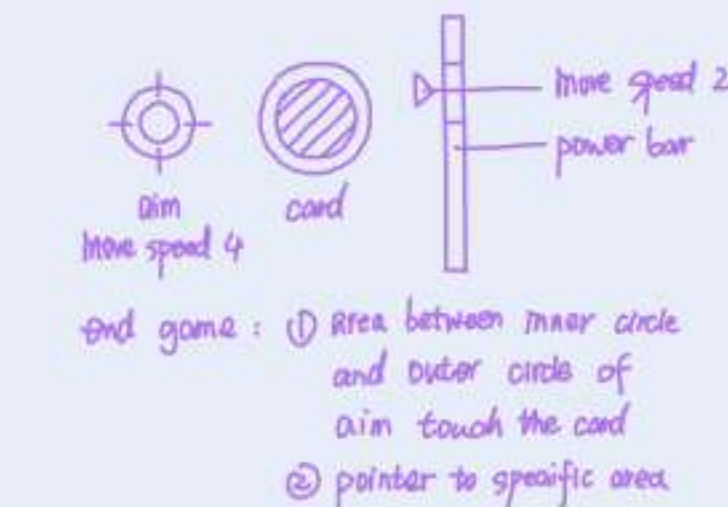
Gameplay Reference



Left click:
Determine aiming point & intensity

Archery:
Players need to
control the fast-
moving aiming
and intensity bar
to shoot arrows.

Sketch



ELEMENT EXPLAIN



Password diary:
Almost all kids have
one in the 2000s



Fishing Game:
Classic game at
children's park



Electronic Pet:
Tamagotchi and QQ
Pet game were popular



Seal:
Primary school teacher
give student a stamp
to express praise



Duck boat:
Duck shape was loved
by children in the past



"Dafengche":
Popular Kids TV
Show in the 2000s



"Tiger-Team":
2000s popular detective
books using puzzle cards
to uncover answers



Card game:
Popular game among
students, winner get
other player's card



QQ:
Popular social media
in China in the 2000s



Milk tea shop:
Students used to write
wishes on sticky note

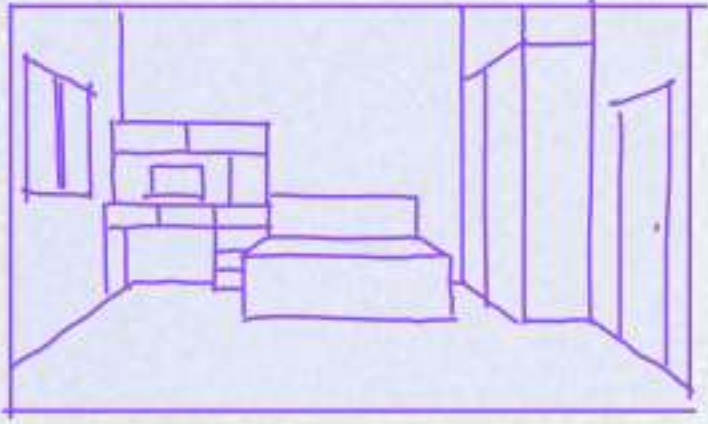


0.5 yuan snack:
Chinese kid's classic
snack — latiao

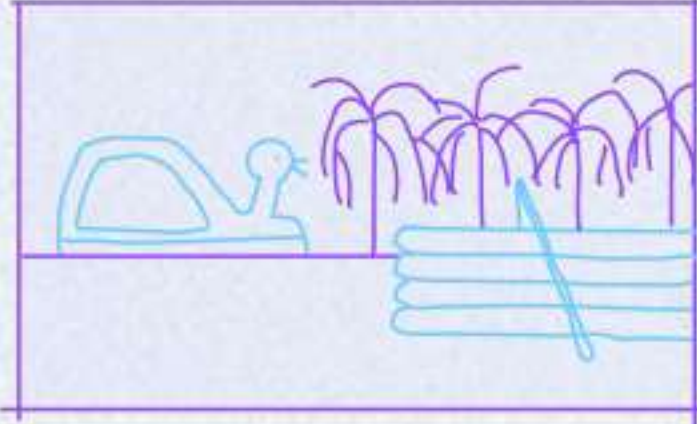


QQ flower vine:
Popular small game
is discontinued now

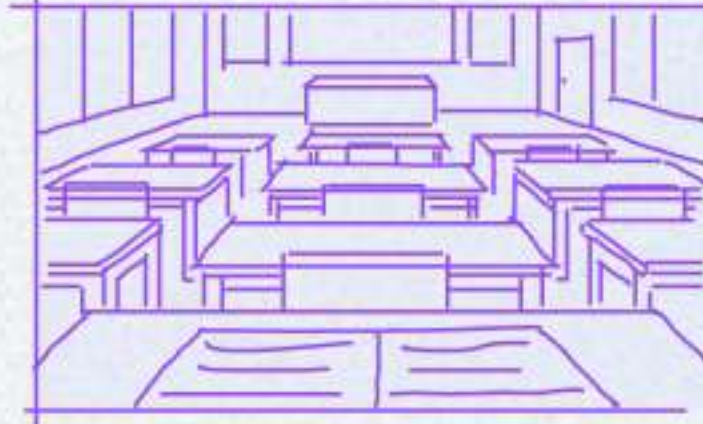
PLOT DESIGN



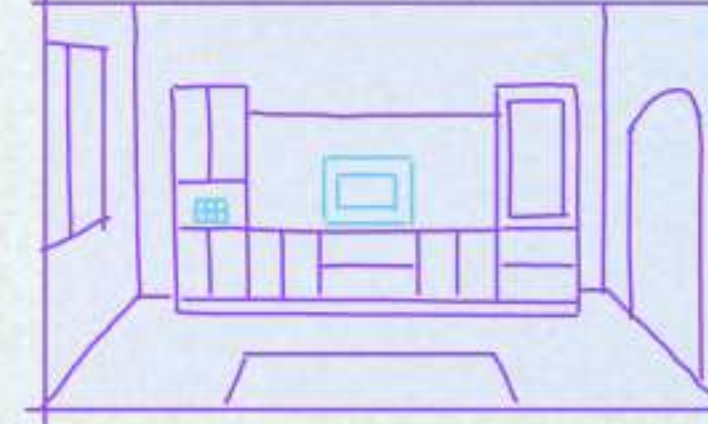
1. Epidemic and job loss in 2023



5. Time travel to children's park and get lost



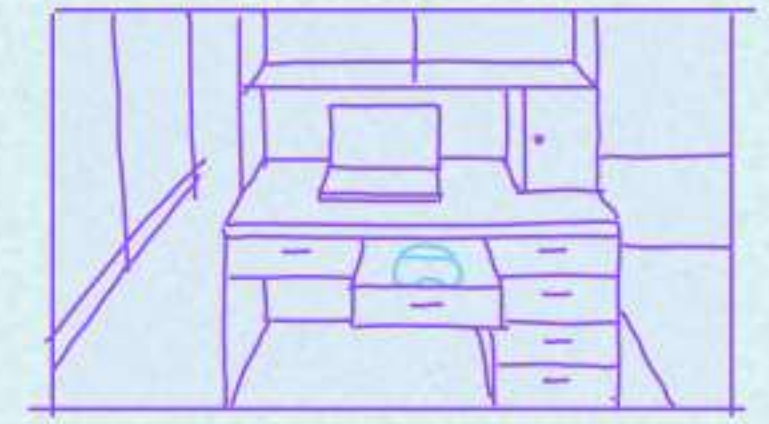
9. Time travel to classroom and get high test scores



13. Time travel to the living room



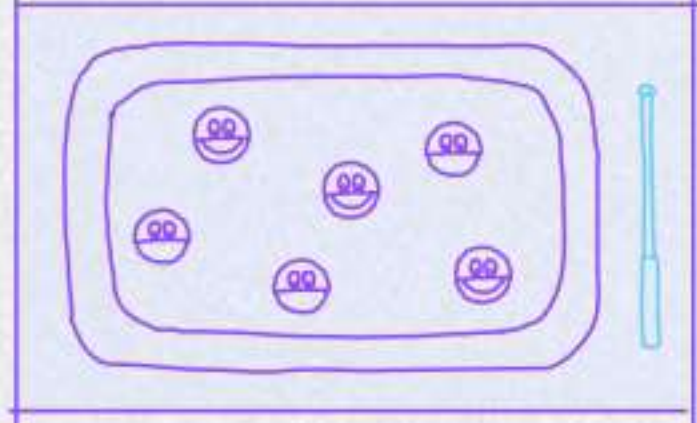
17. Finish homework and play computer



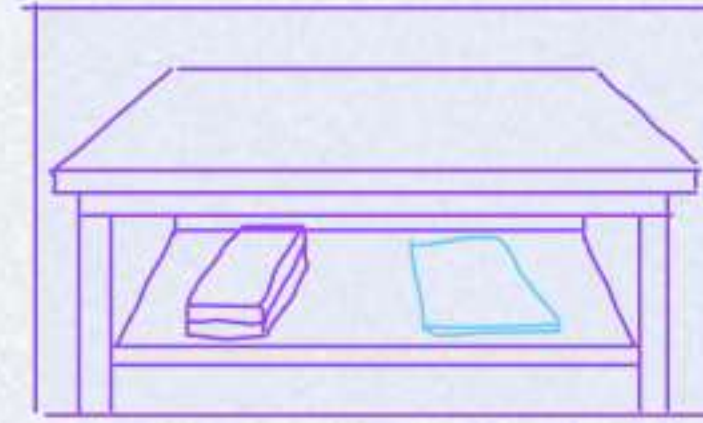
21. Diary disappear and find VR



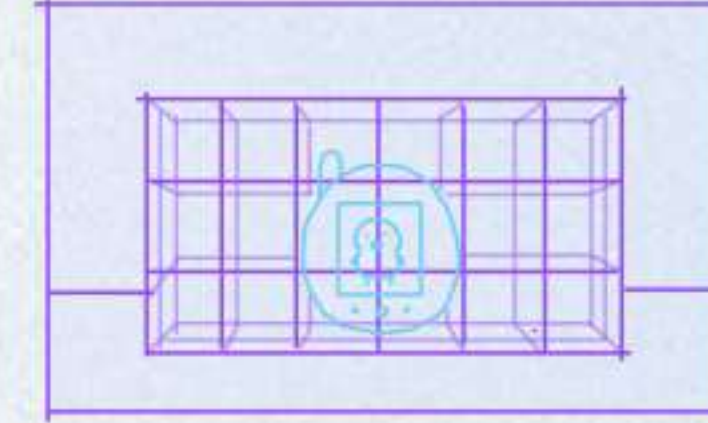
2. Find childhood diary but locked



6. Play fishing game to get boat ticket



10. After class, Read book but no puzzle card



14. Play with electronic pet



18. Chat with friend and play game



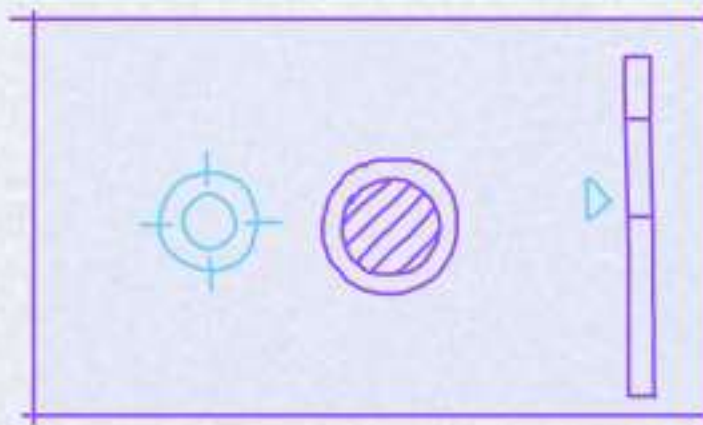
22. Wake up and discover that 2050 is reality



3. Find password on note



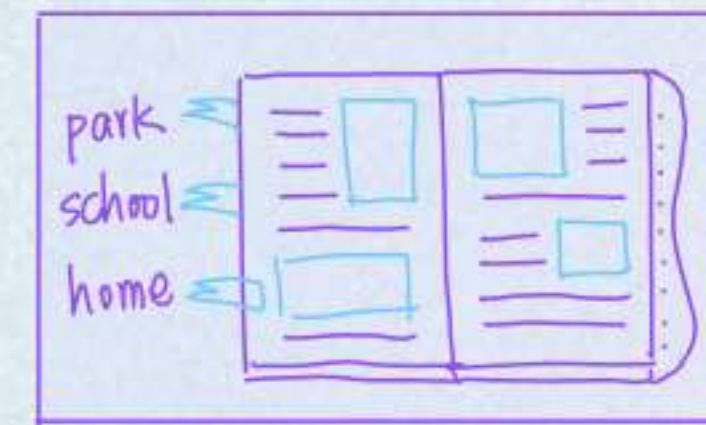
7. One yuan found on duck boat



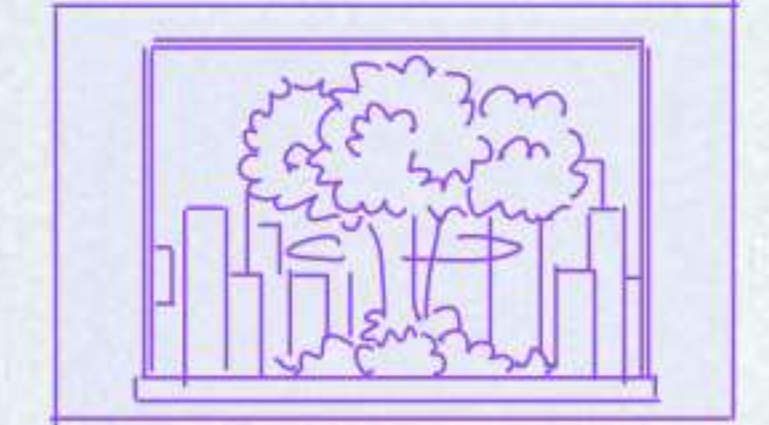
11. Play card game and win puzzle card



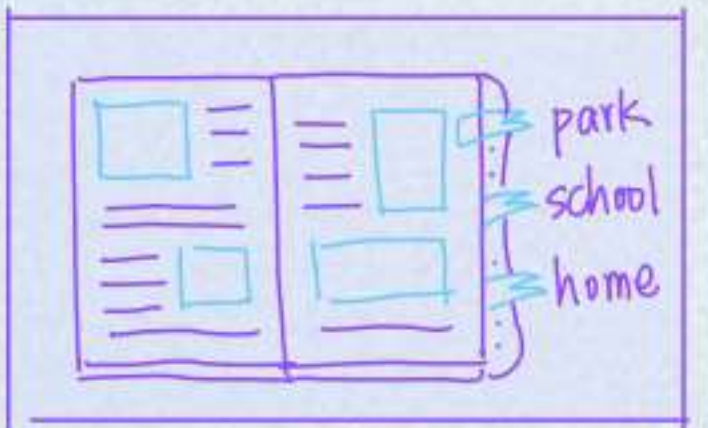
15. Watch favourite cartoon



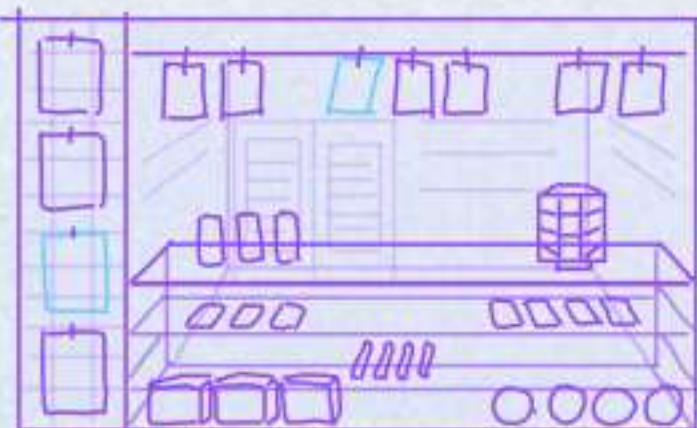
19. Diary became complete



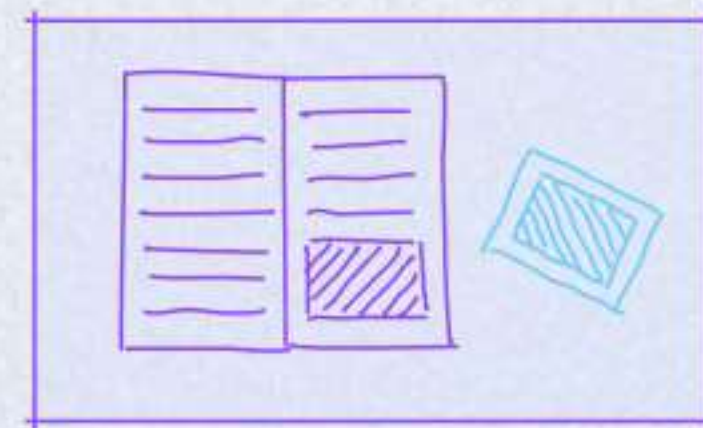
23. War breaks out and friends left



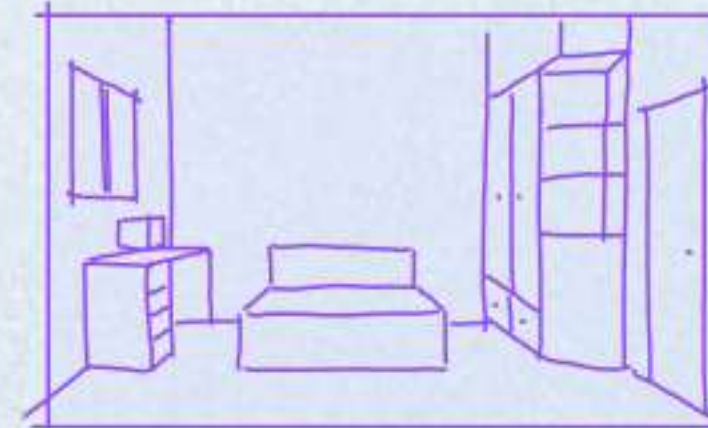
4. Open diary but content incomplete



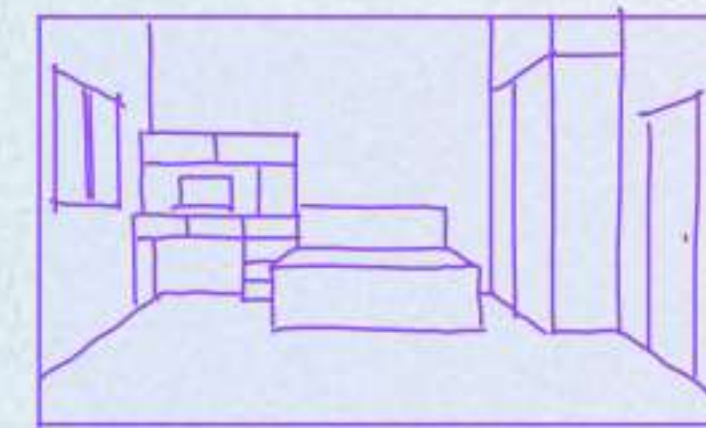
8. Buy snack and card in small store



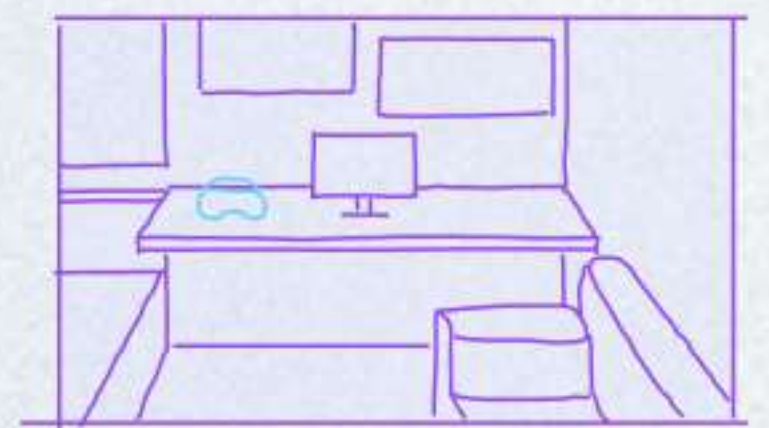
12. Know the ending of book



16. back to bedroom

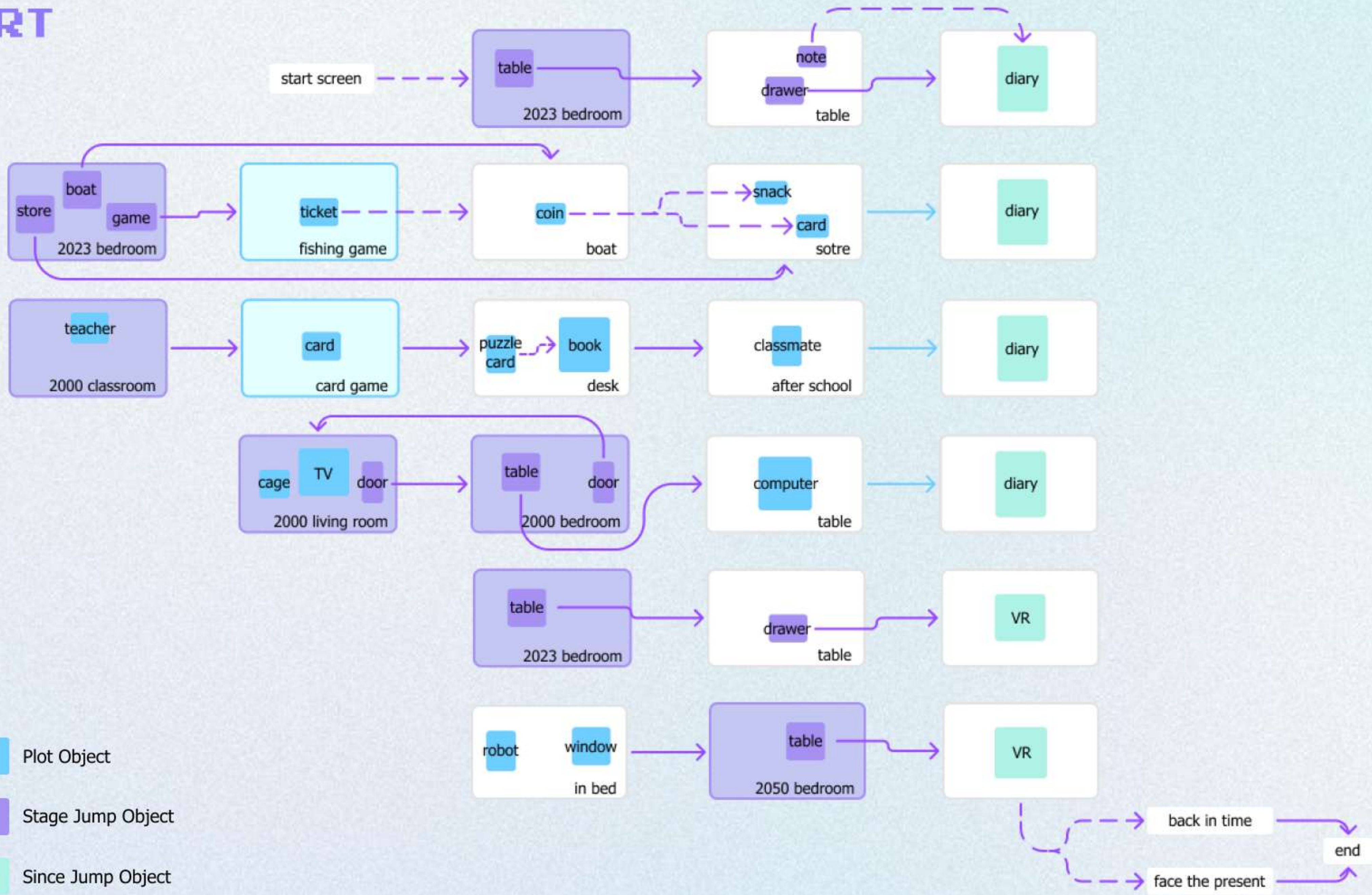


20. Time travel back to 2023



24. Whether to go back to the past again

FLOW CHART



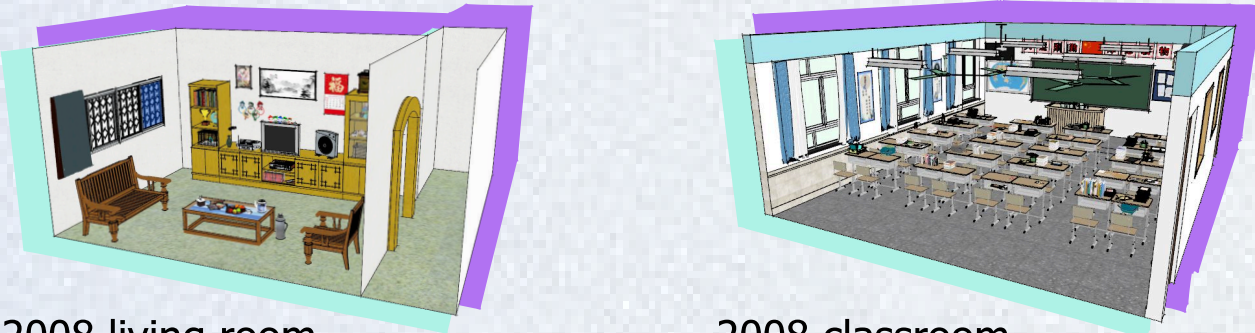
IN THE PROCESS

Github: <https://github.com/Kinley1212>

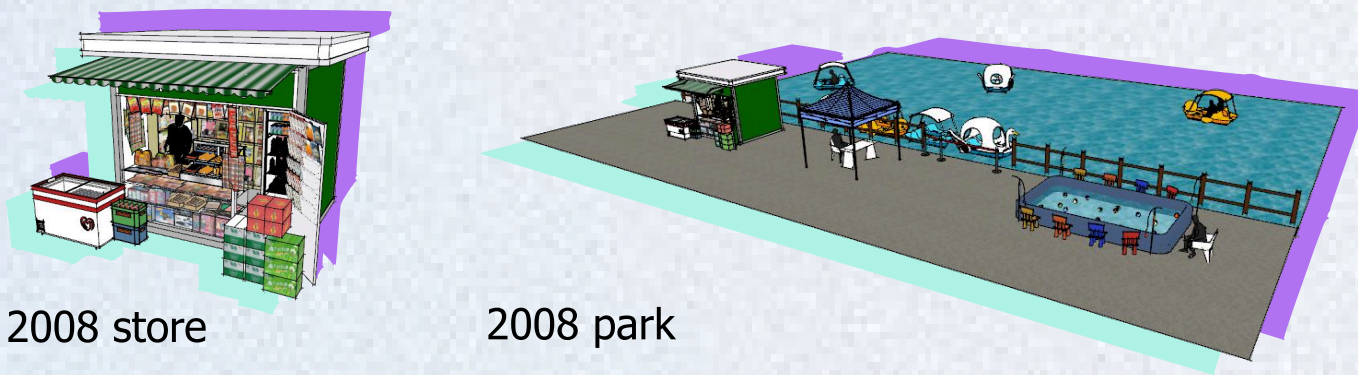
Sketchup Modeling



2023 bedroom 2008 bedroom 2050 bedroom



2008 living room 2008 classroom



2008 store 2008 park

Unity

All Scripts


GameManager


UnityEventHandler


StageLoader


LoadGameManager


CursorManger


PauseMenu


UIManager


DairyButton


DairyNextPage


ItemDairyUnlock


TriggerDairy


ButtonSound


TriggerBox


PuzzleCard


PuzzleOnAera


FishControl


FishObj


CardFlipControl


DialogueManager


DialogueBase


DialogueOptions


DialogueButton


AudioManager


BGMToggle

Game Manager (Partial)

```
private void Awake()
{
    DontDestroyOnLoad(gameObject);
    if (instance == null) instance = this;
    else
    {
        Destroy(gameObject);
    }
}

public bool GetDairy(int dairyPage)
{
    Debug.Log("index:" + index);
    Debug.Log("dairyPage:" + dairyPage);
    index = dairyPage;
    UIManager.instance.dairyImg.sprite = dairy.page[index];
    if (index != dairyPage)
    {
        foreach (GameObject obj in dairy.pagePart)
        {
            obj.SetActive(false);
        }
    }
    UIManager.instance.OpenDairy();
    return true;
}

public bool GetDairy(int dairyPage, int dairyContentIndex)
{
    index = dairyPage;
    contentIndex = dairyContentIndex;
    UIManager.instance.dairyImg.sprite = dairy.page[index];
    dairy.pagePart[contentIndex].SetActive(true);
    if (index != dairyPage)
    {
        foreach (GameObject obj in dairy.pagePart)
        {
            obj.SetActive(false);
        }
    }
    UIManager.instance.OpenDairy();
    return true;
}

public void Load(string stageName)
{
    foreach (stage stage in stages)
    {
        if (stage.name == stageName)
        {
            stage.stageObj.SetActive(true);
        }
        else
        {
            Debug.Log("stageName" + stageName);
            Debug.Log("stage.name" + stage.name);
            stage.stageObj.SetActive(false);
        }
    }
}

public void LoadNewStage(stage[] newStages)
{
    stages = newStages;
}

public void UnlockDiary()
{
    UIManager.instance.dairyBtn.SetActive(true);
}
```

TriggerBox (Partial)

```
public class TriggerBox : MonoBehaviour
{
    public string stageName;
    public bool isOneTimeTrigger;
    public UnityEvent OnTrigger;

    [SerializeField] GameObject[] showObj;
    [SerializeField] GameObject[] destoryObj;

    [Header("First Time Dialogue Settings")]
    public bool isOnce = false;
    public DialogueBase dialogue_1st;

    [Header("Repeat Dialogue Settings")]
    public bool isRepeat = false;
    public DialogueBase dialogue_Repeat;

    [Header("Scene Loading Settings")]
    public string sceneName;

    protected void OnMouseDown()
    {
        if (DialogueManager.instance.inDialogue) return;
        if (EventSystem.current.IsPointerOverGameObject())
        return;
        if (PauseMenu.isPaused) return;
        Debug.Log("ThisClicked:" + gameObject.name);

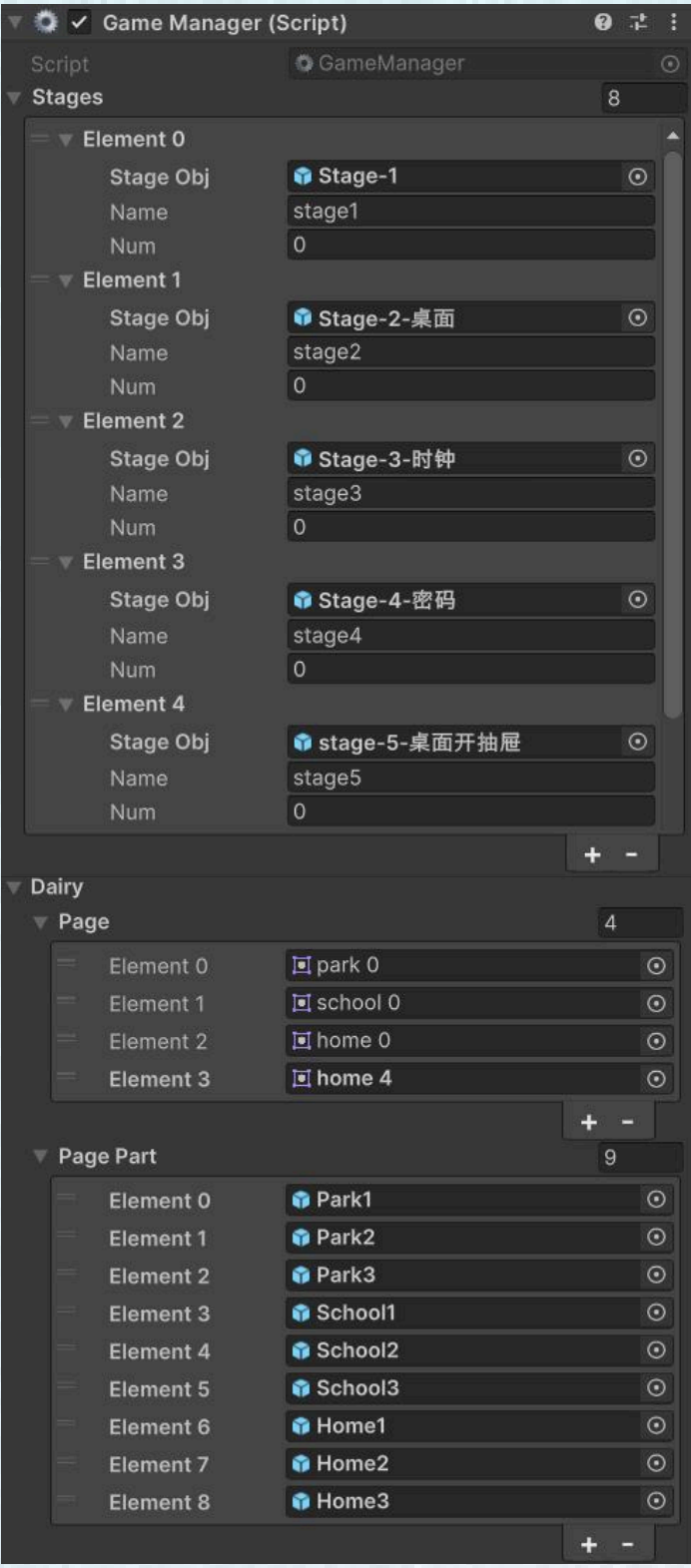
        if (stageName != "")
        GameManager.instance.Load(stageName);
        else if (sceneName != "")
        SceneManager.LoadScene(sceneName);

        if (isOneTimeTrigger) Destroy(gameObject);
        OnTrigger.Invoke();

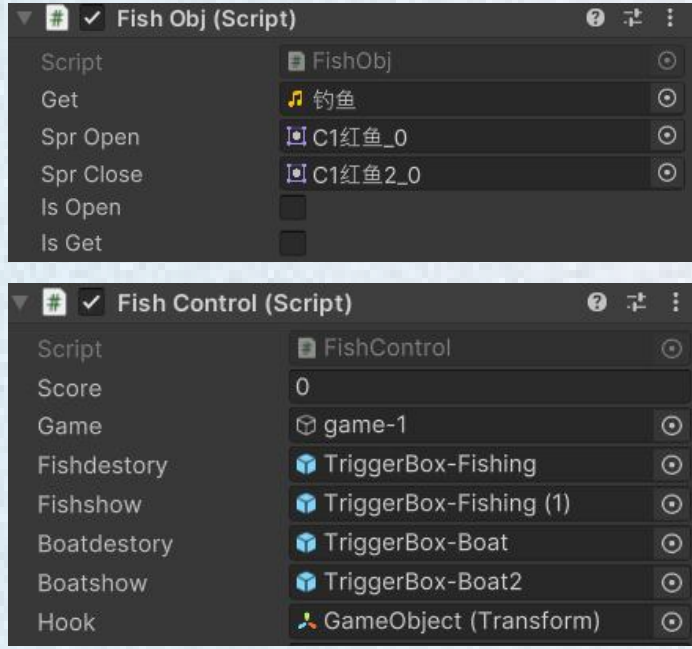
        if (showObj.Length > 0)
        {
            foreach (GameObject obj in showObj)
            {
                if (obj != null) obj.SetActive(true);
            }
        }
        if (destoryObj.Length > 0)
        {
            foreach (GameObject obj in destoryObj)
            {
                if (obj != null) Destroy(obj);
            }
        }
        if (isOnce)
        {
            if (dialogue_1st)
            DialogueManager.instance.EnqueueDialogue(dialogue_1st);
            isOnce = false;
        }
        else if (isRepeat)
        {
            if (dialogue_Repeat)
            DialogueManager.instance.EnqueueDialogue(dialogue_Repe
at);
        }
    }

    public void LoadGame1() =>
    GameManager.instance.Load("game1");
    public void LoadGame2() =>
    GameManager.instance.Load("game2");
}
```

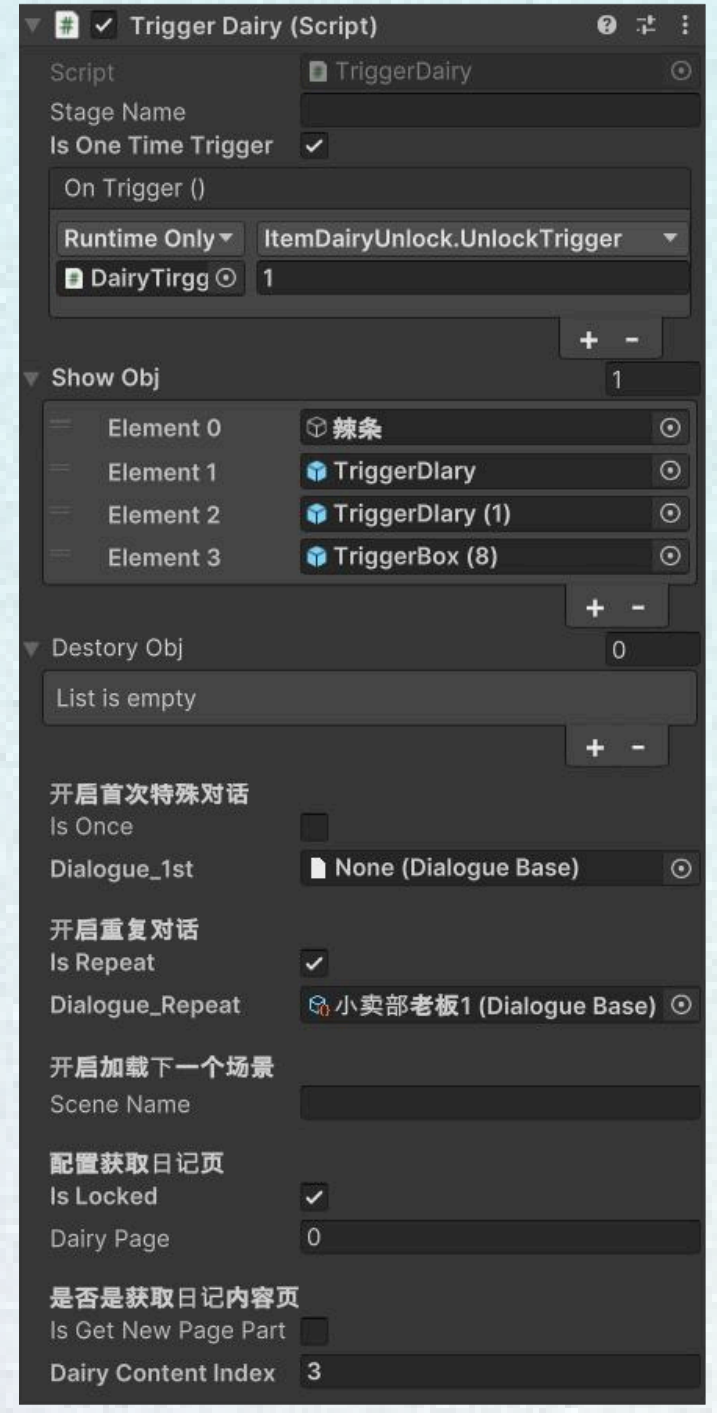
Game Manager



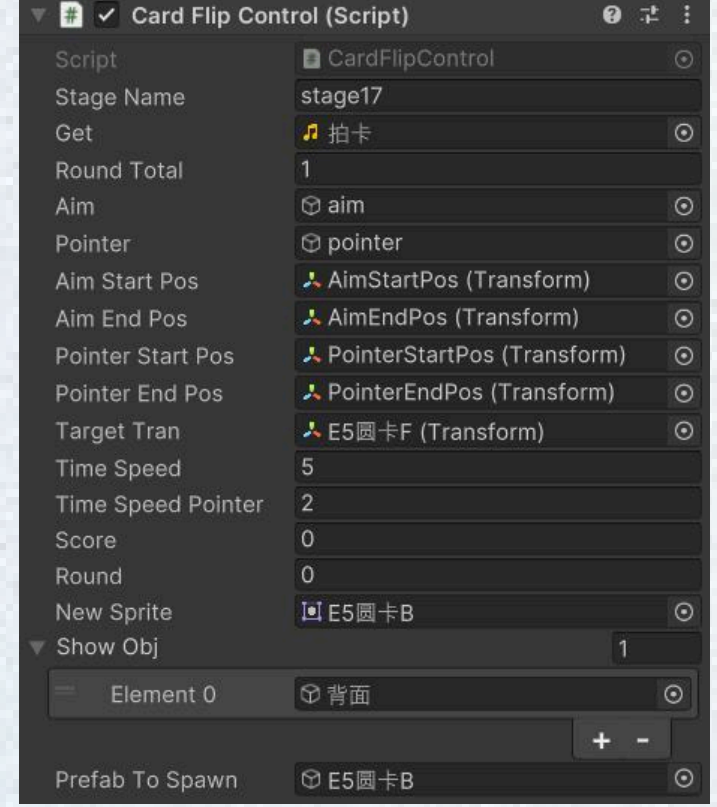
Fishing Game



Trigger Dairy



Card Game



GAME DESIGN

UI Design

Logo



Cursor



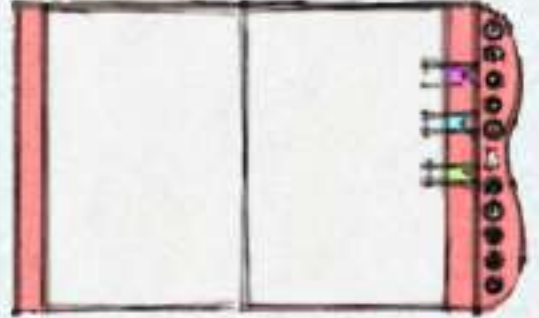
Type

Children's
handwriting

Diary Button

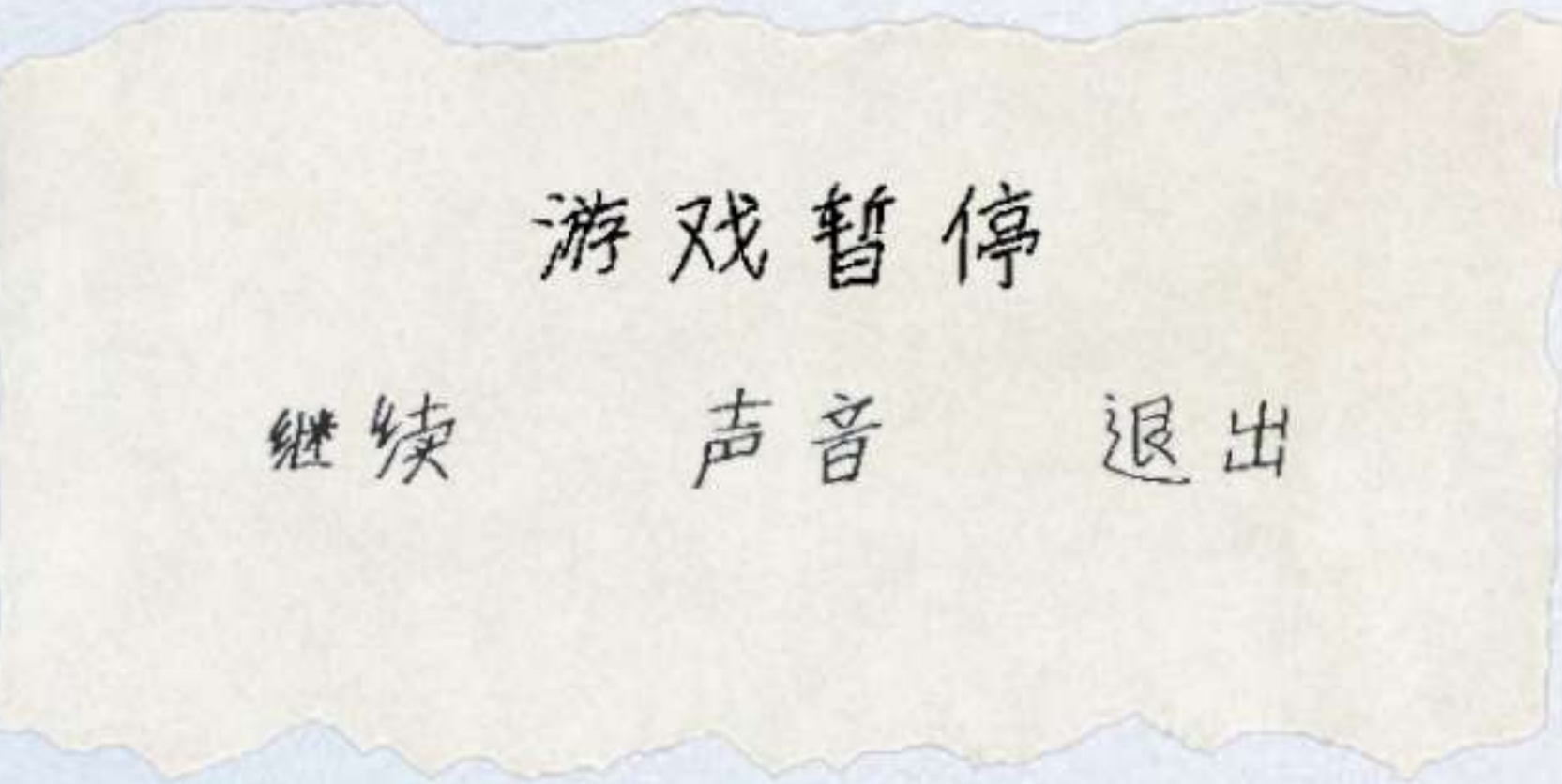


normal



selected

Dialogue Box



Option

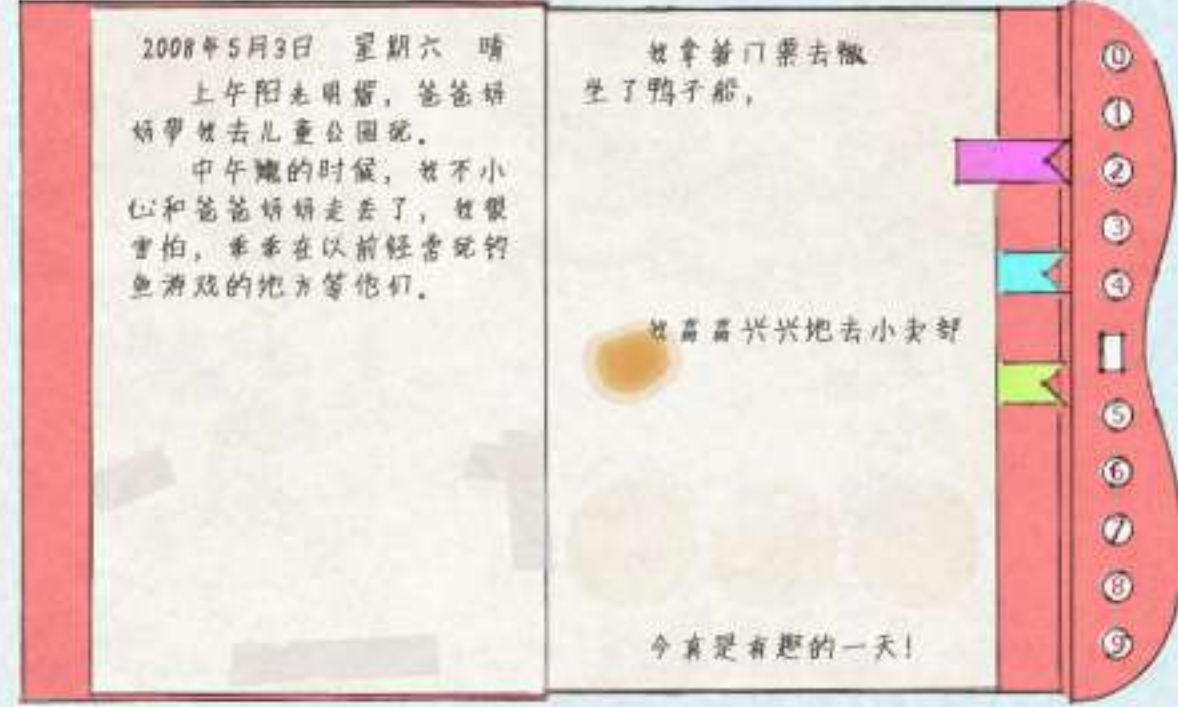


Dialogue Box

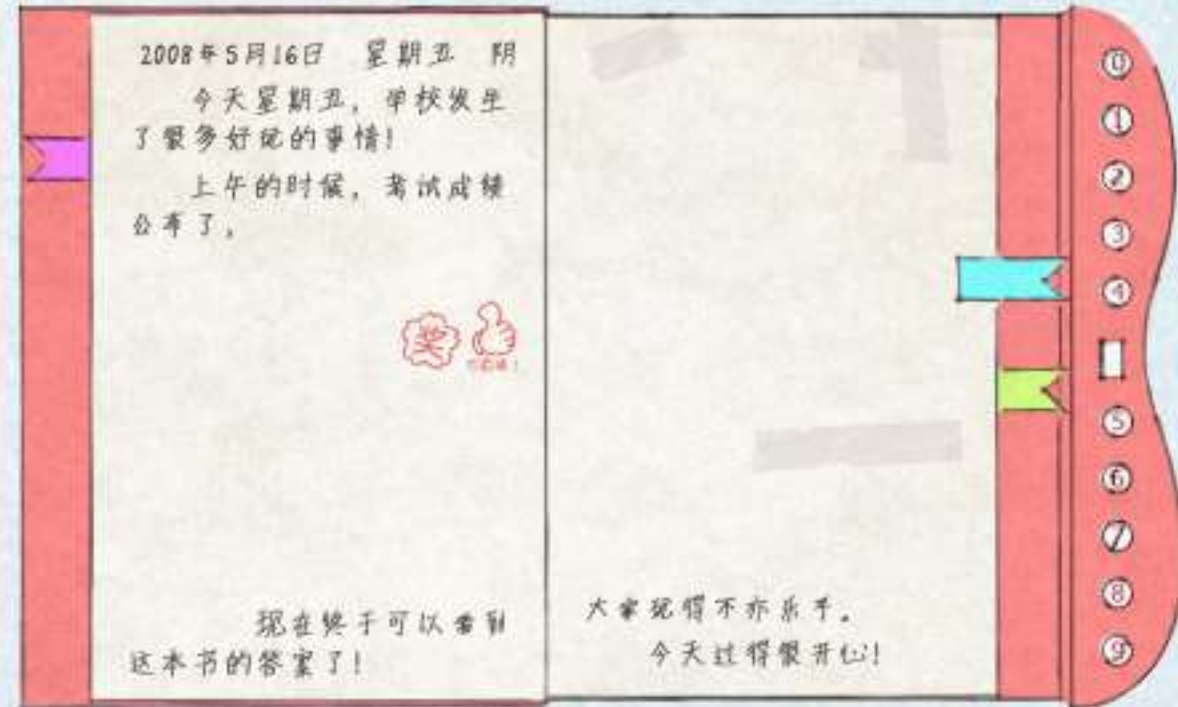


Diary Design

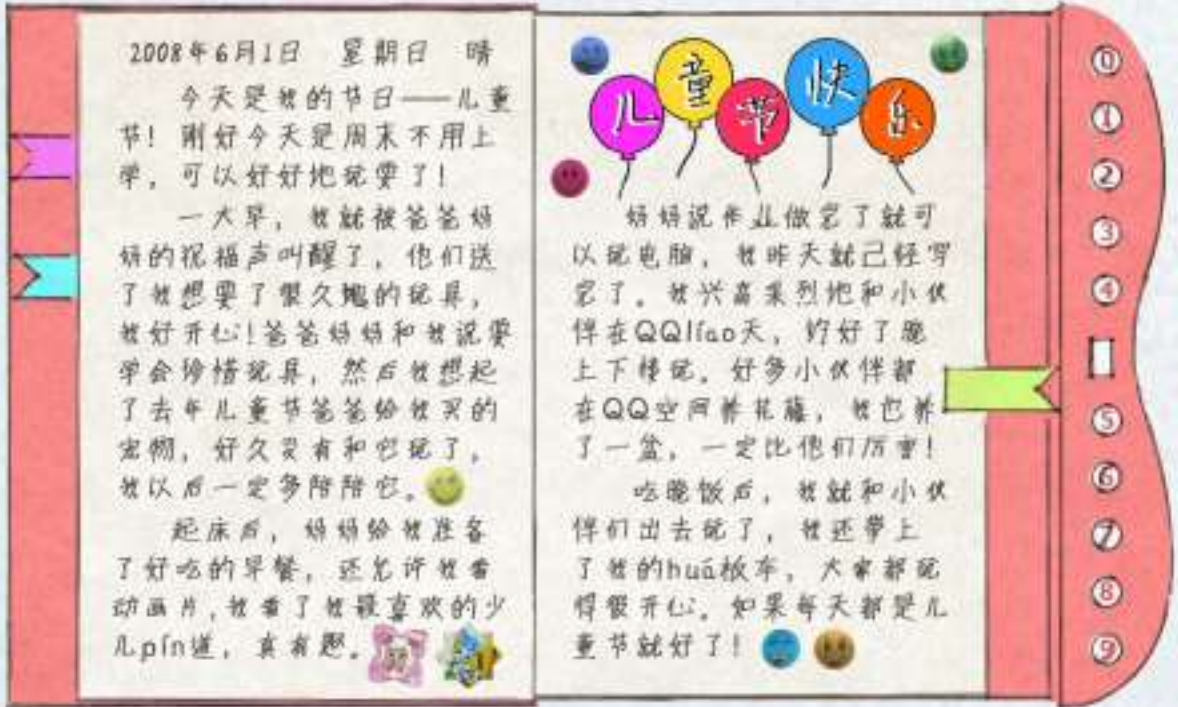
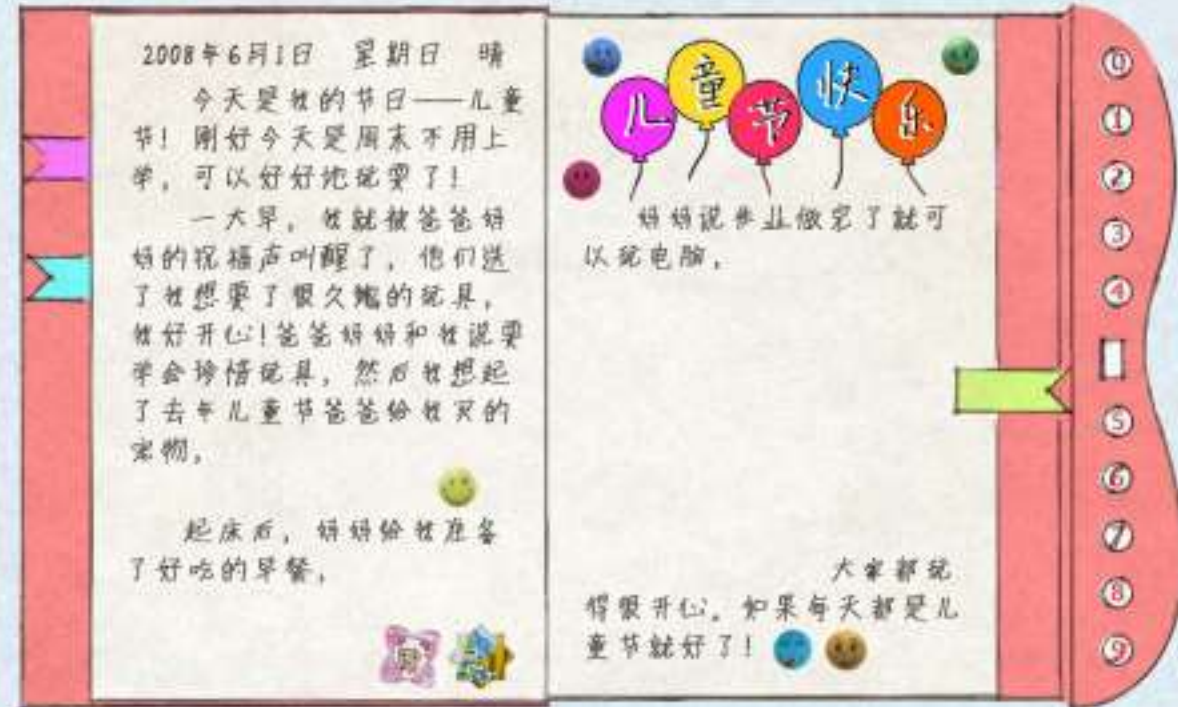
Park



School



Home



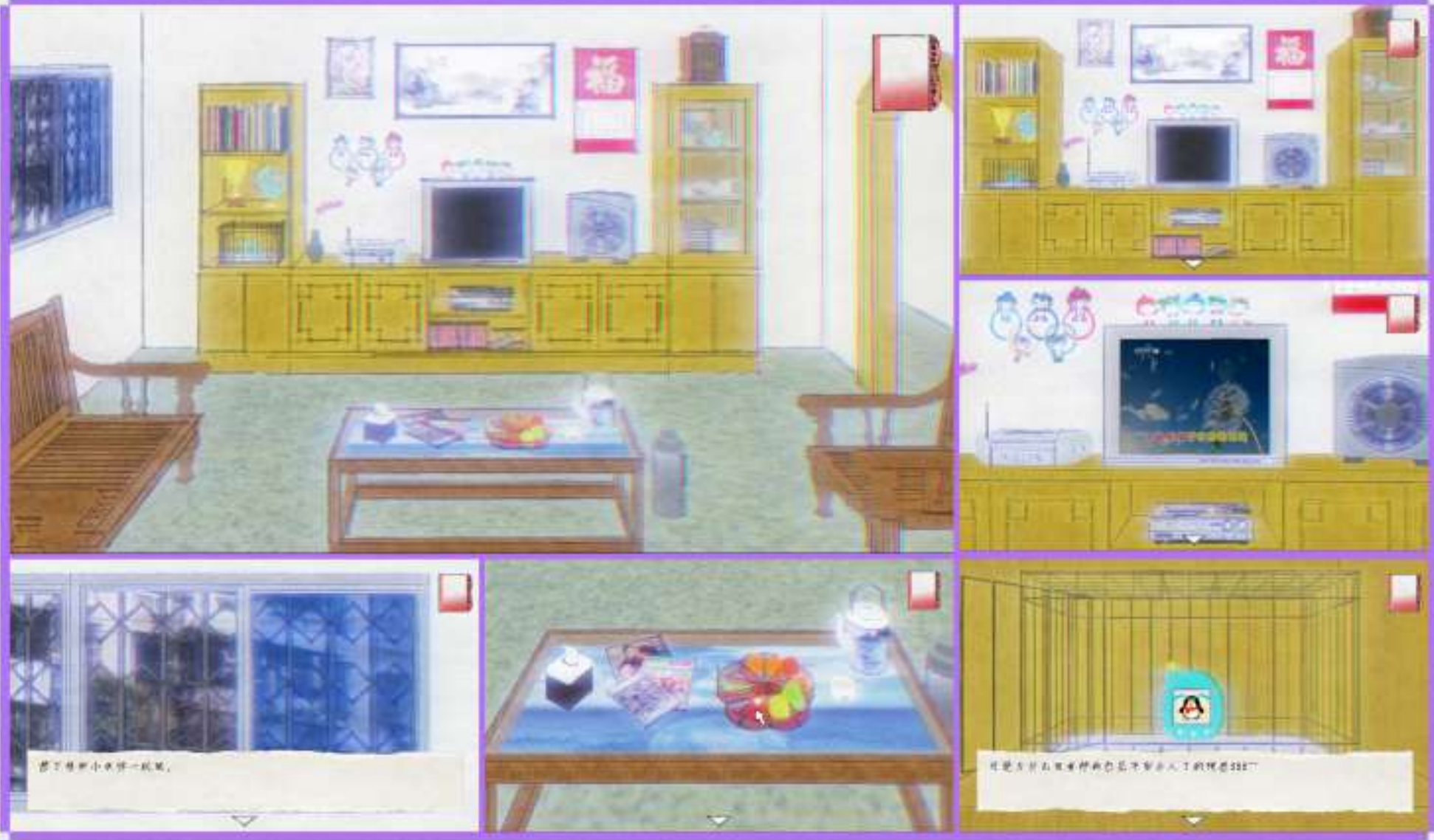
FINAL DISPLAY

Video Link: <https://youtu.be/uCDuJAuavXo>

2008 Park



2008 Living Room



2008 Classroom



2008 Bedroom



FINAL DISPLAY

Video Link: <https://youtu.be/uCDuJAuavXo>

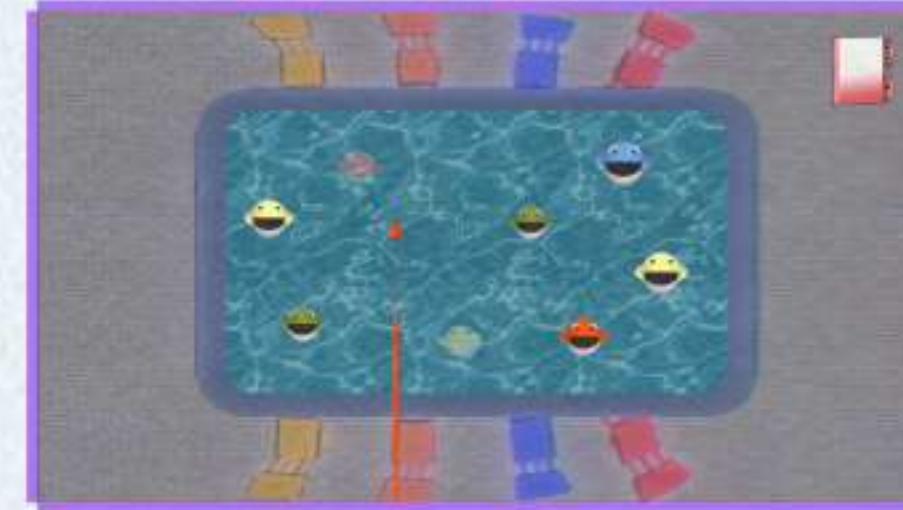
2008 Park



2050 Bedroom



Fishing Game



Card Game



Start Page



End Page



FEEDBACK

Feedback from people who left their email addresses in the questionnaire.



This is the most authentic childhood game I have ever played...



The plot is very good, the story logic is clear and interlocking.



The diary is well restored, with good details.



2008 was really great, but I agree that we should cherish the present.